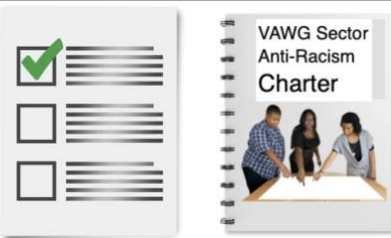


Anti-Racism Working Group

Violence Against Women and Girls Sector - Anti-Racism Charter

Explanations	
 	Black and minoritised women and girls are women and girls who are discriminated against and treated badly because of the colour of their skin, or where they or their families come from. This is racism and it is against the law.
	Black and minoritised organisations are those created by Black and minoritised women to support Black and minoritised women because they did not feel supported by ordinary services, that they did not understand or listened to their experiences. They are also called 'by and for' services.
	White-led organisations are those where the majority of people with most power to make decisions are white, even if not all the staff are white. Most of the largest organisations in the VAWG sector are white-led.

	We are Black, minoritised and white women working in the Violence Against Women and Girls sector.
	We call it the VAWG sector, which means lots of organisations that work to end violence against women and girls.
	We formed this Anti-Racism Working Group in May 2020 to open up a space to talk,
	Black and minoritised organisations that support Black and minoritised women and girls facing violence and abuse are being discriminated against
	and we want this to stop, because they should have the same rights as everyone else and not be treated badly because they are Black or minoritised.
	We wanted to take action and create anti-racist guides and practices for the VAWG sector to help with the work to become clearly anti-racist.

	The strength of the Black Lives Matter movement that summer around the world gave strength to our group's work
	to look at the urgent need for our sector to do the work to end racism in the organisations that work to end Violence Against Women and Girls.
	So we created these guidelines, It is called the VAWG Sector Anti-Racism Charter
	A Charter is an agreement, that we will take these guidelines seriously to become anti-racist in action, not only in words.
	We know organisations are different, some big, some small, some have more money than others.
	We would like the Anti-Racism Charter to help, to learn and stop racism.

What does the Anti-Racism Charter say?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____

The **Charter** says there are 7 key things that need some action, these are:



1. Funding

The money organisations apply for to do their work



2. Partnership and Collaboration

It means working together on some projects



3. Appropriation

When white-led organisations take Black and minoritised women's services and funding

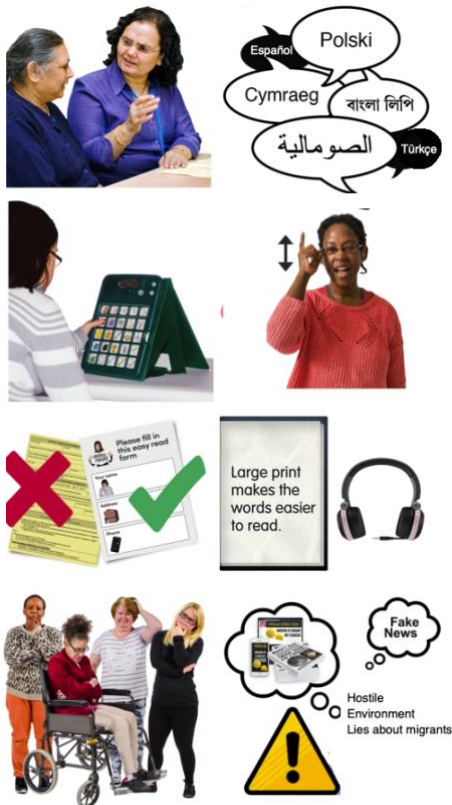
	4. Representation and Engagement Black and minoritised women being invited to meetings where decisions are made that affect them
	5. Leadership and Governance White-led organisations dominate the VAWG sector. Black and minoritised women are hardly represented, and less as leaders. Those with power should encourage diversity and inclusion, including as leaders
	6. Policy and Influencing Black and minoritised women are discriminated against and treated badly, especially migrant women. White-led organisations should always be mindful and inclusive of women discriminated by other inequalities, like race, disability, sexuality, immigration, class, faith

7. Communication

Deliver accessible communications and resources for survivors, tackling all the different barriers women face in getting support, like languages, being deaf, having no speech

Support Black and minoritised women to speak out, ensuring they are treated as experts on their situations

Challenge the media when their reporting is hostile and ask them to engage with Black and minoritised women



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Main actions the Anti-Racism Working Group recommends to VAWG sector

	White-led and Black and minoritised women's organisations agree principles and commitments of equality and fairness about getting funding
	Agree to tell funders and the government that we need Black and minoritised women's organisations
	Work to make sure that all meetings invite Black and minoritised organisations Make sure that events like conferences or workshops include the voices of Black and minoritised women
	When working together, Black and minoritised women are involved from the beginning, and not after everything has been decided
	When working together, we agree together how to deal with disagreements and problems, from the beginning



White-led organisations don't take work away from Black and minoritised women, but work together as equals, from the beginning



Make sure that Black and minoritised survivors' voices are heard in services, including children



Every organisation who agrees with the Charter sets up a diversity, equality and inclusion group to work on it and report to their Board



They also create ways to check progress on diversity, lived experience and equalities in everything they do, and report on this regularly

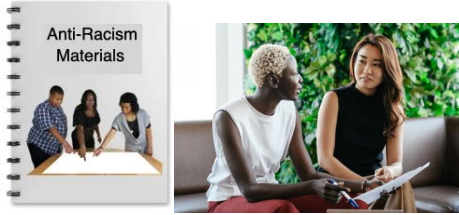


The diversity, equality and inclusion group is involved when there is a complaint about racism or other inequalities and writes down how it is dealt with



If staff are not happy with how it is dealt with, an independent way should be looked into

	Every organisation signed up to the Charter makes sure that when they do their plans they are thinking about Black and minoritised survivors and all the different inequalities
	Top managers and board members in white-led organisations learn about anti-racism and use the materials provided by the Anti-Racism Working Group to help with this
	They also provide opportunities for staff and others to learn about anti-racism and white dominance
	Organisations who sign up to the Charter can check how they are getting on, by using guidelines and tools available
	When they get new staff, they do it in anti-racist ways to get more equality and more Black and minoritised women as staff, volunteers and also on the Board of trustees
	Create coaches in the VAWG sector, so that younger Black and minoritised women in white-led organisations can get support from more experienced Black and minoritised women from another organisation

	To create a pot of money from everyone in the sector to fund this coaching
	White-led organisations support Black and minoritised staff to meet with other Black and minoritised staff in the sector, as part of their work
	Also for white staff to be able to work on anti-racism and meet others in other organisations to become strong anti-racist allies
	Black and minoritised women who contribute to anti-racism work in their organisations will have their work valued, including emotionally, as part of their work, not extra work
	White-led organisations doing anti-racism work will prioritise Black and minoritised organisations when they get consultants to help them
	Organisations with members help their white-led member to share their anti-racist and equalities work with others, to share ideas and good practice

	and will share with Black and minoritised organisations too.
	In campaigns, think of how it will affect Black and minoritised women and others discriminated against, and take their needs into account
	White-led organisations ask for advice from Black and minoritised women in groups and government consultations, recognising this and paying them when possible
 Please join us! Yes we will...	When white-led organisations realise that Black and minoritised women have not been invited to important meetings, they make sure they tell the organisers White-led organisations make sure they organise events with Black and minoritised women and that they are included in invitations
	White-led organisations share contacts of people with power with Black and minoritised women's organisations, for example contacts for journalists, politicians and government officials

	Black and minoritised women are included in the organisation's communications (like written things, or presentations or videos, or fundraising)
	Organisations provide accessible communications and resources for survivors, and make sure their budgets include money for translation and accessibility from the beginning
	White-led organisations share media and publicity opportunities with Black and minoritised women's organisations and they always ask journalists to contact Black and minoritised women's organisations first on things that are about them.

**If you want to know out more
about the Anti-Racism Working Group
and the Anti-Racism Charter**

**Please email
antiracismvawg@gmail.com**